



YOUR ROOM IN THE SKY

First Class seats cocoon you in comfort, providing you with enough space and services to just sit back and relax



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to end up on a newer, well-maintained plane. Expect wide, spacious cabins, quieter engines, and, in some cases, a dedicated bar and lounge area where you can stretch your legs.

And finally, there's that little something extra that makes each airline stand out. Take Emirates, for instance. If you're travelling on a full-fare Business or First Class ticket, they'll throw in complimentary chauffeur transfers at both ends. This perk really helps in cities like Tokyo, where a taxi from Narita Airport to the city can set you back around \$300 each way. Singapore Airlines offers "Book the Cook" and lets you pre-book your meal in advance when flying in premium classes. While there are numerous options, I always go for their signature Chicken Satay, followed by the Lobster Thermidor. Then there's Qatar Airways; their Dine-on-Demand service is a game changer. You're no longer at the mercy of set meal times. Instead, you're offered an à la carte experience, choosing what you want and when you want it.

AT YOUR SERVICE

The real benefits start at the airport. Unlike in Economy, you don't have to deal with the stress of online check-ins or worry about a few extra kilos in your luggage. Chances are, if you've got frequent flyer status, they'll let most

things slide. But the real luxury? Skipping the endless security and immigration lines that can make airports like New Delhi or Mumbai feel like an endurance test.

Once onboard, you're greeted by name, escorted to your oversized seat, and within minutes, a glass of Champagne appears, along with a set of soft pyjamas, of course. The cabins are spacious, designed to give you privacy, though products such as Qatar's 'QSuites' even have privacy doors that slide shut. And the privileges don't stop there. Last year, I flew 10,644 miles on what's dubbed 'the world's longest flight'—Singapore to Newark direct. My 18-hour journey flew by, as Singapore Airlines' free in-flight Wi-Fi worked flawlessly, even allowing me to stream YouTube and Netflix, making time fly almost as fast as the plane.

Then there's the food. Many airlines partner with celebrity chefs: Qatar Airways has Chef Ton from Le Du, Bangkok, while Air France has Julien Royer from Odette, Singapore, curating their menus. Singapore Airlines takes it a step further with an entire culinary panel featuring famous names like Georges Blanc and Yoshihiro Murata, as well as our very own Sanjeev Kapoor. While this all sounds great in theory, be warned that the quality of airplane food largely depends on where your flight takes off from and which catering company the airline works with.